



MONTHLY UPDATE

China activities: monthly update, August 2026

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14 places. Every block below is carried verbatim from that place's own monthly update, where it was written, sourced and checked; nothing is written here.

ALGERIA · BOTSWANA · BURKINA FASO · CHAD · GAMBIA · KENYA · NIGER · NIGERIA · SENEGAL ·
SOUTH SUDAN · SUDAN · TOGO · ZAMBIA · ZIMBABWE

The place reports do not share one window; the period above is the range they span.

Algeria

The country was named a [founding member, from 16 July, of a 29-country artificial-intelligence organisation headquartered in Shanghai](#). No instrument of accession, obligation, contribution or programme of work is on the record here.

Botswana

China's ambassador [publicly offered AI cooperation in smart mining, digital government and talent training, pitching Chinese AI technology as a lever for economic diversification and pointing to a July 2026 pledge of 5,000 AI training places for developing countries and AI application cooperation centres for bodies including the African Union](#). It is an offer rather than an instrument: no Botswanan response, memorandum or programme is on file.

Burkina Faso

The month's only Chinese item is an approach rather than an agreement: the communications minister and a Burkinabe delegation were [received at a Chinese broadcaster's Beijing headquarters on 22 August 2026 to examine partnership in audiovisual and digital broadcasting, the exchanges going to the terms of collaboration with the national broadcaster and the national transmission company](#). No memorandum, commitment, value or timetable is stated.

Chad

The financing that did arrive in the window came from one partner. Chad and China [signed two grant agreements totalling 300 million yuan, in tranches of 100 million and 200 million that the minister of state called immediately mobilisable](#), for infrastructure and social development with digital technologies supported alongside; and earlier in the week the Chinese ambassador [announced 5,000 scholarships in technology and artificial intelligence](#). Neither carries a project list, a digital allocation or a timetable, and the local-currency equivalents in circulation differ between outlets on their own conversion dates.

Gambia

Chinese engagement remained visible as training rather than infrastructure. The embassy [announced twenty-five further Gambians travelling to China in September under ministry grants, with a vocational workshop and a laboratory planned](#). The broadband and fifth-generation work the ambassador [named in 2023](#) still carries no contract, value or date. A second channel opened at official level: on a visit to Guizhou University the country's permanent representative in Geneva [announced four initiatives](#) — the Guizhou Provincial Big Data Laboratory as a data-governance research centre for the UN science and technology commission, a national data laboratory in The Gambia replicating it, scholarships in big data and artificial-intelligence governance, and a joint summer school. They are announcements, not agreements: no text, funding or timetable is held, and none is a Gambian government instrument.

Kenya

The e-commerce cooperation memorandum with China was [cited as the basis for dispatching eighteen ICT officers to Shandong](#), framed inside the digital master plan. The memorandum's signature date, terms and text are not held.

Niger

China's newly arrived ambassador [met the vendor's vice-president to discuss deepening cooperation](#). The vendor has operated in Niger since 1998 and a [2014 export-credit loan of RMB 623.7m built a 2,275 km domestic fibre backbone completed in 2017](#); no Chinese financing or vendor contract after 2017 is on record.

Nigeria

On 27 August Huawei [launched an agentic artificial-intelligence cloud in Nigeria at its own Lagos summit, running on local cloud infrastructure it offers with data residency, security, compliance and low-latency claims for finance, telecommunications, internet services, government and enterprises](#). The technology development agency's director-general used the platform to set out the National Sovereign Cloud Initiative as the route from consuming technology to leading African cloud and artificial-intelligence innovation, and the Lagos deputy governor said the state is building the digital foundations for artificial intelligence rather than waiting for it.

Sovereignty language attaching to a foreign vendor's platform is the pattern here rather than the exception: the same company's [Lagos innovation centre opened in May 2025 to a ministerial framing as a catalyst for the country's technology sovereignty](#). No customer, contract, capacity or price is stated for the cloud launch, and the residency and compliance claims are the vendor's own.

Senegal

The sovereign cloud is [in testing, with data-centre infrastructure deployed and verified for redundancy and reliability to host sensitive national data on Senegalese territory](#), accelerated ahead of an international sporting event. No contract, value, hosting term, exit arrangement or data-access terms are reported — a sovereignty claim resting on a vendor relationship whose terms are not held.

South Sudan

On 31 August the ICT minister was reported to have [held exploratory talks with a Huawei vice-president in Hangzhou, on the sidelines of a China-Africa digital capacity building conference, saying the government is ready to seek the company's expertise in connecting public services](#). Beyond e-governance, participation is sought in building smart cities, providing energy solutions and setting up a national data hub in Juba.

This is a repair, not an opening. [Government officials accused the company in 2014 of hacking government emails and forging documents](#); it stayed in the market through the rift, connecting schoolchildren to the internet and refurbishing school laboratories, and the restoration is credited to two officials who took post in 2025, whose [meeting in Juba in early 2026 covered the digital divide, the data hub and a smart capital](#). Nothing has been agreed: no contract, memorandum, workstream or figure is on record, which is where this relationship stood in February and where it still stands.

Sudan

The China relationship acquired a physical address. Sudan's minister of digital transformation and communications [attended the opening of a digital cooperation centre with China](#). Until this month the base held nothing at all on Chinese digital engagement with Sudan. What it still holds nothing on is the instrument behind the centre, its value, or what it is to do.

Togo

Togolese officials [toured China's G60 science and technology corridor on 31 July](#) during a seminar run by the Chinese commerce ministry, with partnerships, internships and training named as prospects. Nothing was signed. The standing instrument remains a [protocol concluded with Huawei in September 2024](#) whose text, amount, scope and timetable are unpublished.

Zambia

A [seminar on China-Zambia artificial-intelligence cooperation](#) covered localising artificial-intelligence solutions to Zambian conditions and partnering with universities on curricula, and a ministry director and the Chinese ambassador [discussed digital infrastructure, emerging technologies, skills and research](#). No agreement, value, timetable or named institution follows from either.

Zimbabwe

A Harare forum [argued that cooperation with China will help African countries build technological capability](#), with the terms of technology transfer the point at issue. The account is carried by Chinese state media, which is part of what it evidences. No project, transfer arrangement or commitment is named in it, so it records an argument about the relationship rather than a movement within it.

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